# The Shade of Strategy

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Original BCG Perspectives circa 1969. Courtesy BCG Archive

You are looking at the original operating system of modern strategy.

The Boston Consulting Group was the first advisory firm fully specialized in strateg
Founded in 1963 by Bruce Henderson, it soon began sending essays called *Perspecti*
to executives around the world.

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These were not long reports or "press releases." Henderson's *Perspectives* arrived on executives' desks printed on textured, heavy paper in this specific shade of dusty green. There were no photographs. There was only a title, a premise, and an argum

I remember them clearly. Those green pamphlets were brief but dense with insight. They respected your intelligence, not your patience. The quality and originality of t thinking were the sales pitch.

When I first met Henderson in late 1966, he was excitedly exploring the implicatior of what he named The Experience Curve. He told me:

> *"The key issue is how some firms outperform their competitors and maintain their lead.*

> *The standard explanation is economies of scale, but that cannot explain how leaders sta ahead. The experience curve explains it."*

His *Perspectives* on the experience curve shaped thinking about strategy for a decad as did the subsequent *Perspectives* on the product portfolio.

Henderson promoted the idea that effective strategy grows out of comprehending t forces at work in a situation—out of a clear diagnosis. Today, the modern business world has largely forgotten this.

Strategy is not planning. It is not simply setting goals.

A "Perspective" is different. A Perspective is a distinct way of seeing a challenge. It triggers the realization that the problem you thought you had is not the problem yo actually have.

I am renaming this publication **The Rumelt Perspectives** to align my work with tha standard.

You will notice the design of this site has changed. The "Rusty Green" you see on tl buttons and links is not a decoration; it is a citation. It is a nod to that paper stock from 1967.

It is a reminder to me, and a promise to you, that we are not here to add to the nois We are here to parse gnarly situations and define a way forward.

Welcome to *The Rumelt Perspectives*.

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Nathan Krupa The Country Disciple Jan 28

I can't wait to read more!

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Ty Hagler Jan 28 *Edited*

Solid brand statement. “Promise made” with Dusty Green. I look forward to reading the “promise kept”

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